

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Publishing Digit

All the jargon bandied about within these walls...

Kerning: Kerning is the process of adjusting the space between pairs of letters so that they look appealing. Nestling an 'e' under a capital 'T', for example

Tracking: The process of adjusting the space between characters. Unlike kerning, this is indiscriminate and doesn't account for aesthetics

Leading: The space between the lines of text

Orphan: When the first line of a paragraph appears at the bottom of a column, it's called an orphan

Widow: When the last line of a paragraph appears at the top of a column, that's a widow.

Bleed: When an image or text extends beyond the margins of the page and touches the edge of paper, it's bleeding

Blurb: Blurbs are those lines of text that are smaller than the headline but bigger than the text. Blurbs help the readers understand what the article is about

Callout: Text or symbols that are used to identify parts of an image. The text may be enclosed within balloons or boxes

Usage: The current *leading* dimensions for articles in *Digit* are 11pt. In terms of other elements in page design the articles in *Digit* occasionally display *bleeding*. *Blurbs* for articles are a must, as well as removing *orphans* and *widows*. We use *tracking* and *kerning* to *optimise* space. *Callouts* are done if the visual calls for them.

Wild Wild Web

The New Villains

In an America hit by housing crisis and sub-prime credit crunch, housing brokers have become the favourite punching bag. A canny estate agent and Website creator has put up Web sites like **IHateMortgageBrokers.com** and **AngryMobTShirt.com** where the teeming masses can safely vent their anger and disgust without getting entangled in a court case or going to jail.

These sites work by offering the luckless and hapless a space to sign an online petition demanding better regulation of mortgage industry. And in the great American tradition of tee

shirts and capitalism, these Websites sell tees with customised slogans starting from mildly offensive to totally unprintable.

A mob of tee wearing homeless folks marching on to the offices of housing brokers and raising hell? Whee!

Surf Before You Drive

If you are an average motorist, you would have at least one brush with the constabulary over matters like crossing speed limits or jumping red lights. In case you live in the US or UK you would never be forced to cough up hefty fines or grovel before a judge begging for leniency if you ever check out **www.njection.com**.

This Website, which is free for use, lists all the speed traps and red lights in US and parts in London. The information that is put on the Website is user submitted and gathered anonymously. Just before your journey check out the placements on your route or even download them into the GPS of your car for a fee.

Predictably, local bodies are not amused with the idea of forewarning drivers as they are losing a fat amount of revenue in the form of fines. However, for the most part officials are looking at this service in a positive way: motorists slow down in areas with red lights because of the site, so that's good.

locking," he said.

The Linux creator went on to state that security people are often the black and white kind of people that he can't stand.

Torvalds appeared particularly irked by the creators of the OpenBSD operating system, who have focused on security and auditing when developing their variant of Unix. OpenBSD is known to be used in high-security environments such as the U.S. Federal Bureau of Investigation.

"I think the OpenBSD crowd is a bunch of masturbating monkeys, in that they make such a big deal about concentrating on security to the point where they pretty much admit that nothing else matters to them. To me, security is important. But it's no less important than everything else that is also important!" Torvalds concluded.

Well the comment confirm that Linus never really looked into OpenBSD. Judging the whole project by few vocal whiners isn't really constructive.

We would like to remind you that OpenBSD folks contribute enormously—and not only on the security front. From several projects, the recent highlight is OpenNTPD, which is rather simple and most importantly a working implementation NTPD protocol.

The comments sound like much of the usual chestbeating we are used to seeing to make all the fanboys and girls on the lists swoon; realistically it just demonstrates an ignorance of the OpenBSD project. We don't know what Linus' beef is. He seems to be on the same page with respect to this issue. And the "masturbating monkey" thing? Well that's just plain funny!

PARENTAL NEGLIGENCE

Baby For Sale

If you are a frequent user of eBay, then you are probably expecting to find all sorts of products available through online auction. With all that, a German couple from Memmingen

decided to take online auctions on eBay to a whole new level. So, they posted an advertisement to sell their son, claiming he had become "too loud" to keep.

The starting bid was set at 1 Euro, which prompted the boy's 23-year-old mother, Tanja, to claim that the auction was only a joke, despite the fact that the post ended with bold letters demanding that the baby be picked up in person.

The advert, entitled "Baby—Pick up in Person Only" offered shoppers information about the baby's gender and size. It also stated the parents' reason for selling him.

The post, which has been removed from the online auction site in the meanwhile, got no bidders in the two hours and thirty minutes it was displayed. Renee Beck, a police spokesperson in Krumbach, near Munich, stated that the German police are investigating the two parents on suspicion of child trafficking. The German police was aided in tracking down the two parents by eBay officials. The parents

maintained that the posting was just a joke gone awry.

MAPMANIA

Mapping Out Of Disasters

Modern technology—especially the Internet—has been usually of great help in times of natural disasters like floods or hurricane. The Internet enables the bad news to filter out quickly and keeps the rest of the world informed about how things pan out, as well as speeding up the relief efforts. But sometimes we have to admit, people become too gung-hoish in dreaming up uses for the Internet in situations involving natural disasters.

Consider this idea—a collaborative map of a particular area hit by some disaster like flood or earthquake. On the face of it, the idea seems feasible and lifesaving. After all , what can go wrong if you have an online map hosted

Sir Yes Sir!

The funniest thing that happened this month went as follows:
Ring! Ring! (Rohit, our art director's phone)
Rohit: Hello
Caller: Hi, it's Pramath.
Rohit: Yes sir, hello! *(Dr Pramath Sinha is our MD)*
Caller: Hello?
Rohit: Yes sir, I'm sending the

cellphone cover right away.
Caller: Cover? No cover, I'm calling about a mobile connection.
Rohit: Huh?
Caller: Vodaphone connection?
Rohit: Huh?
Caller: Sir this is Pramath from Vodaphone!

Rohit:
&%@\$*#^%!

DIGIT DIARY

on a remote server which would show, in real time the locations of bridges that were washed away 30 minutes ago, roads flooded by a mudslide 5 minutes ago or maybe buildings that have toppled over. Knowing all those details would be definitely helpful when you rushing to save your life, or save others lives. And it is doable too: users would just have to drag red markers on the screen and maybe type a small description. Crowdsourcing at it's best and the end to all those helicopter sorties where

rescuers squint from binoculars looking for white flags and what not. Not so fast there. What this system assumes is that everyone in a potential disaster zone would have Internet connection and a mobile device small and light enough to carry around and people would somehow magically stop and type instead of saving themselves and their valued possessions. The reality is a lot different. First of all, even in the most advanced countries wireless internet access works in the best of circumstances. To expect people to remain

online when they are faced with matters of life and death and also when basic infrastructure facilities have been wiped out seems unrealistic.

The folks at sites like GeoCommons and Mapufacture where these maps are hosted and available freely to everybody affirm that maps help in the event of, and not during a particular disaster. However even then, with basic infrastructure utilities like electricity down how effective this system will be across different locations remains doubtful. Even the people behind these services admit that their services don't work as well in the real world as they do in controlled environments.

For India, things would not change for a very long time, no sir. We would be happy if in the event of we getting caught in a flood or a cyclone somebody gets food and shelter for us. We can check our e-mails later. ☒

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Blog

WATCH

Featured here are snippets from some of the best bloggers who have registered at the Blog Watch section on thinkdigit.com.

If you wish to be featured too, head to www.thinkdigit.com/blogger.php and sign-up.

Anurag Panda
<http://tinyurl.com/6dtsyt>
[http://dogbuntu.wordpress.com/2008/05/15/ma king-hardy-heron-as-lts-is-a-tactical-mistake/](http://dogbuntu.wordpress.com/2008/05/15/making-hardy-heron-as-lts-is-a-tactical-mistake/)

Making Hardy Heron as LTS was a tactical mistake
In April Canonical released Ubuntu 8.04 LTS more popularly known as Hardy Heron. It was the eighth Ubuntu version to be released so far but more importantly it is an LTS release which means that it would be supported 3 years for the desktop and five years for the servers.

....Now with such a history of remarkable success that Dapper had, Hardy falls far too short....In fact things that worked in Gutsy did not work in Hardy. In my case for instance Compiz does not work as I made it work in Gutsy.

.. the developers should have released Hardy as a standard release and should have tested, and debugged for six more months and should have released its next version as LTS....For the time being the Ubuntu developers are releasing Hardy 8.04.1 in July and I hope it irons out

several bugs and does make Hardy deserving to qualify as an LTS release.

Pallab De
<http://tinyurl.com/6x42m8>
<http://www.pallab.net/2008/07/20/3-websites-and-2-softwares-for-all-your-subtitle-needs/>

3 Websites and 2 software for all your subtitle needs
If you are a movie buff like me who watches a lot of foreign movies then this post is for you... I present before you three websites and 2 software to help you hunt down that elusive subtitle.

Podnapisi.net: This is the first place I visit whenever I need a subtitle. The major advantage podnapisi has above other subtitle services is the awesome search engine.....This is the best option for TV Show buffs, as podnapisi allows you to locate subtitle for a specific episode from a specific season easily...